BUSINESS MODEL TO TEST

Could focused review software help industrial operators?

Potential users span small operators, contractors, and managed OT security providers. This is a customer discovery plan, not a market-size estimate.

Who may buy or champion

Municipal water and wastewater utilities; power and energy operators; oil and gas infrastructure; industrial maintenance contractors; managed OT security providers; and defense-support facilities. Likely champions include an OT security lead, plant engineering manager, asset owner, CISO, or managed-service practice owner.

Position relative to existing products

Public product pages describe established industrial security platforms and risk, compliance, and audit tools. OTProof is not positioned as a proven replacement. Its hypothesis is a small source-linked review workflow that may connect equipment records with existing security, maintenance, and audit systems.

Category	Publicly described capability	OTProof implication
Claroty	Industrial equipment inventory, security risk management, network protection, secure access, and threat detection.	Competes for broad industrial security budgets; possible data/workflow integration.
Tenable	Industrial equipment inventory, risk prioritization, remediation guidance, integrations, and compliance reporting.	Broad incumbent; MVP has no coverage or accuracy advantage claim.
Nozomi	Asset discovery, firmware details, vulnerability assessment, network visibility.	Potential integration target; no comparative test run.
Risk / audit tools	Risk assessment, controls, compliance, and audit workflow, e.g. ServiceNow.	Potential downstream record system; integration is future work.

The idea to test

The product idea is to put exact equipment/notice evidence, careful handling of missing information, and a record of human decisions in one focused workflow. Existing products may already solve the problem. Interviews and integration trials must show whether an additional tool helps.

Evidence to test: product coverage, agreement with engineer decisions, missed affected assets, quality of cases sent to review, review minutes, setup effort, integration demand, willingness to pay, and renewal interest.

EXAMPLE PRICES AND COSTS

A possible site subscription and setup fee

A transparent first model makes the assumptions easy to challenge before a commercial forecast is attempted.

Scenario inputs

Assumptions: 3 licensed sites per customer; $36,000 annual license per site; and $25,000 one-time setup per new customer. Annual recurring revenue (ARR) is the yearly subscription income. Gross margin is the share left after direct delivery costs; the example assumes 78% for software and 40% for setup services. First-year revenue adds the subscription and setup income. Estimated gross profit applies those margins to each income source.

Customers	Sites	Recurring ARR	Year-1 revenue	Year-1 gross profit
1	3	$108,000	$133,000	$94,240
5	15	$540,000	$665,000	$471,200
10	30	$1,080,000	$1,330,000	$942,400
25	75	$2,700,000	$3,325,000	$2,356,000

Illustrative arithmetic only. The scenarios are not customer commitments, an addressable-market calculation, bookings, or a revenue forecast. No revenue has been generated by this MVP.

Potential contract structure

Possible contracts include a yearly site subscription, a multi-site enterprise plan, setup and connection fees, and optional ongoing review services. Some operators may prefer software installed inside their own environment to protect sensitive equipment lists. Each option needs cost and procurement validation.

Illustrative labor sensitivity, not measured savings

Assume 80 assets, 12 relevant equipment/notice pairs per year, and a reduction in the initial review from 30 to 15 minutes per pair. That yields 240 theoretical hours, or $19,200 at an assumed $80 staff cost per hour. This excludes engineering work after review and assumes every pair realizes the time reduction. The MVP has no human time study, so this is not measured savings.

FINDING CUSTOMERS AND TESTING VALUE

Sell a measurable workflow improvement, not an AI promise

A controlled design-partner pilot should prove that the tool fits plant roles, records, and approval practices before product expansion.

Commercial route

Begin with 3-5 pilot partners from water, energy, industrial maintenance, or managed OT security. Offer a local installation or isolated IT setup for approved sample inventories. Start with spreadsheets, then connect to a maintenance or risk-management system only if pilot users show a recurring need. Sell setup as help preparing inventory records and configuring the workflow, not as automatic risk removal.

Customer value to measure

Measure review minutes per equipment/notice pair, data gaps found, agreement with engineers, cases where an affected asset was missed, cases sent to human review, evidence completeness, time to export an audit package, setup hours, and continued use after the pilot. Potential benefits include less repeated source lookup, clearer audit evidence, and earlier engineering assessment. Those benefits remain hypotheses until measured; OTProof does not itself establish compliance or reduce operational risk.

Key risks and response

Weak inventory quality can limit results; expose stale/missing data and assign owners. Advisory parsing can miss vendor nuance; preserve source excerpts and abstain. Established products may duplicate capabilities; position as complement and integrate. Sensitive asset information limits cloud adoption; test local deployment. Human review still costs time; quantify actual time saved and false-positive burden. Buyers may reject price; test paid pilots and renewal intent.

Sources and market context

Competitor summaries are based on public vendor pages, not independent product tests: Claroty (claroty.com/platform), Tenable (tenable.com/products/ot-security), Nozomi (technicaldocs.nozominetworks.com/guardian), and ServiceNow risk tools (servicenow.com/docs). Full links are in docs/RESEARCH_NOTES.md. Pricing, margins, customer conversion, and savings assumptions are illustrative.

Before expanding: confirm that engineers agree with results across several vendors, uncertain cases are sent to review, local deployment is acceptable, sources are traceable, review time improves, and buyers are willing to pay.